

Find Hours — budget reconciliation, effort only

Hours / effort only. No dollars, rates, or headcount. Synthetic data.

The formula $\text{Net findable} = (\sum \text{Planned} + \text{Contingency}) - \sum \text{EAC}$
 $(850 + 40) - 831 =$
59 h

When a new ask lands — 4 steps

1. **Reallocate under-run slack** from tasks tracking under plan (planned – EAC, floored at 0).
2. **Draw contingency** (management reserve) for whatever slack does not cover; log what it funded.
3. **Defer / re-sequence** lower-priority scope to free planned hours this period.
4. **Change order** for the residual: lead biostat + PM review, sponsor sign-off, SOW amended.

Absorbable vs change order

Ask 45 h → Absorbable internally

19 h from under-run slack + 26 h from contingency, 0 residual.
Reserve left: 14 h.

Where the numbers come from

Column	Source of record
Planned	SOW / budget grid in CTMS
Actual to date	Timesheet system
% complete, EAC	Your estimate + progress tracker
Change order	Contract: PM review + sponsor sign-off

Ask 90 h → Change order needed: 31 h

19 h slack + 40 h contingency exhausted, **31 h** residual = new scope. Goes to the change-order process.

Where it runs — the systems

- **SOW / budget grid (CTMS)** feeds planned hours into the ledger.
- **Timesheet system** feeds actual-to-date.
- **Your estimate + progress tracker** set % complete and EAC.
- **The tool** rolls these up; it connects to none of them. You transcribe current figures in, so the reconciliation is attributable and stands on its own.
- **Contract process** (lead biostat + PM review, sponsor sign-off, SOW amended) handles any residual.

Read the ledger — worked

- Per task, **under-run slack** = $\max(0, \text{planned} - \text{EAC})$. A task forecast under plan gives up slack; a task over-running ($\text{EAC} > \text{planned}$) is **watched, not raided**.
- Sum the per-task slack to get **net slack** (19 h here), then add **contingency** (40 h) for **net findable** = 59 h.
- Source a new ask in order: slack first, then contingency, then the residual is a change order.

Thresholds — how far an ask can go before a change order

Ask size	Sourced from	Verdict
Up to 19 h	Under-run slack only	Absorbable, reserve untouched
19 h to 59 h	Slack + contingency	Absorbable, reserve drawn (log it)
Above 59 h	Exceeds net headroom	Residual is a change order

Run it `shiny::runApp("budget_reconciliation/shiny")` The KPIs and verdict recompute live as you edit an EAC or change the ask. Hours / effort only; pricing is handled downstream by the PM.